Georgia Works to Rebuild Trust in Its Elections

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In a warehouse in Paulding County, Georgia, workers are unpacking voting machines and testing them for logic and accuracy. The checks are part of a statewide routine as Georgia prepares for **midterm** elections next month, to make sure every vote is counted correctly.

Ballot **scanners**, made by Dominion Voting Systems, are each locked in six different places to stop **tampering**. Lacy Dunn, the assistant elections director in Paulding County, says workers test every race, every candidate, every piece of equipment, and every ballot.

Brad Raffensperger, Georgia's secretary of state for the past eight years, oversees the work and stays in daily contact with all 159 counties. Georgia has been at the center of a national debate since President Donald Trump made false claims about its role in the 2020 election, and Raffensperger refused to help **overturn** that result. In January, FBI agents searched the Fulton County election **headquarters** and took hundreds of boxes of 2020 election material; almost nine months later, no charges have been brought. Some voters are unsure, while others feel hopeful their vote will be counted.

Word Treasure

scanners -- Machines that read and count marked ballots.

tampering -- Secretly changing something in a wrong way to affect the result.

midterm -- An election held in the middle of a president's term, when many other leaders are chosen.

headquarters -- The main office where an organization does its work.

overturn -- To undo or reverse a decision or result.

Background you need

In an election, voters choose leaders by marking ballots, and machines help count those ballots.

Before voting day, election workers test the machines again and again to make sure every choice is counted correctly.

These checks matter because people need to trust that the final count truly shows what voters decided.

Break it down

WHO: Election workers in Paulding County, Lacy Dunn, Brad Raffensperger, and Georgia voters.

WHAT: Testing voting machines and ballot scanners before midterm elections to make sure every vote is counted correctly.

WHERE: A warehouse in Paulding County, Georgia, with work across Georgia's counties.

WHY: To make sure every vote is counted correctly and rebuild trust after debate about Georgia's elections.

Why it matters

When you grow up and vote, you will want to know that your vote is counted correctly, just like the voters in this story.

Test what you remember

1. What are workers in Paulding County unpacking and testing?

- (A) Data center computers
- (B) Ballot boxes from Fulton County
- (C) Voting machines for logic and accuracy
- (D) New power plants

2. How many different places is each ballot scanner locked in?

- (A) Ten different places
- (B) Six different places
- (C) One warehouse
- (D) Three different places

3. Who oversees the election work and stays in daily contact with all 159 counties?

- (A) Brad Raffensperger
- (B) Lacy Dunn
- (C) Donald Trump
- (D) A warehouse worker

4. According to Lacy Dunn, what do workers test?

- (A) Only the ballots
- (B) Only the candidates
- (C) Only the voting machines
- (D) Every race, every candidate, every piece of equipment, and every ballot

5. What did FBI agents do in January, according to the article?

- (A) They locked ballot scanners in six places
- (B) They tested voting machines in Paulding County
- (C) They searched the Fulton County election headquarters and took hundreds of boxes of 2020 election material
- (D) They counted votes for the midterm elections

6. Why are the checks being done before the midterm elections?

- (A) To change the constitution
- (B) To unlock barrels of oil
- (C) To make sure every vote is counted correctly
- (D) To build a data center

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: A 4: D 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Unsure voters: They are unsure whether their vote will be counted.**
2. **Hopeful voters: They feel hopeful their vote will be counted.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):